MINI GUIDE • NEW USERS • MEDIA TRUST TOOLS

Copy, verify,
and prove it.

This one-page guide introduces the three tools new operators need most: **CopyTrust** for managed ingest, **Drop Verify** for one-folder artifact creation, and **Folder Copy Compare** for a direct "did the copy work?" answer.

CopyTrust = ingest workflow

Drop Verify = trust package

Folder Copy Compare = post-copy check

Start with this rule of thumb

- Use **CopyTrust** when you are copying from a source to one or more destinations.
- Use **Drop Verify** when the folder is already copied and you want MHL, PDF, and CSV artifacts.
- Use **Folder Copy Compare** when you simply need to compare two folders and repair gaps.

Choose The Right Tool

These apps overlap on purpose, but each one is optimized for a different operator question.

COPYTRUST

I need to offload media safely.

Best for camera cards, staged copy sessions, relay chains, and verified multi-destination ingest.

- One source to one or more destinations
- Queued jobs and relay chains
- Copy, verify, MHL, receipts, logs, optional proxy beta

DROP VERIFY

I already have a folder and need proof.

Best for creating a deliverable trust package from a single folder without running a copy session.

- Creates `.mhl`, contact sheet PDF, EXIF/media CSV
- Reads one dropped folder recursively
- Great for handoff, reporting, archive prep

FOLDER COPY COMPARE

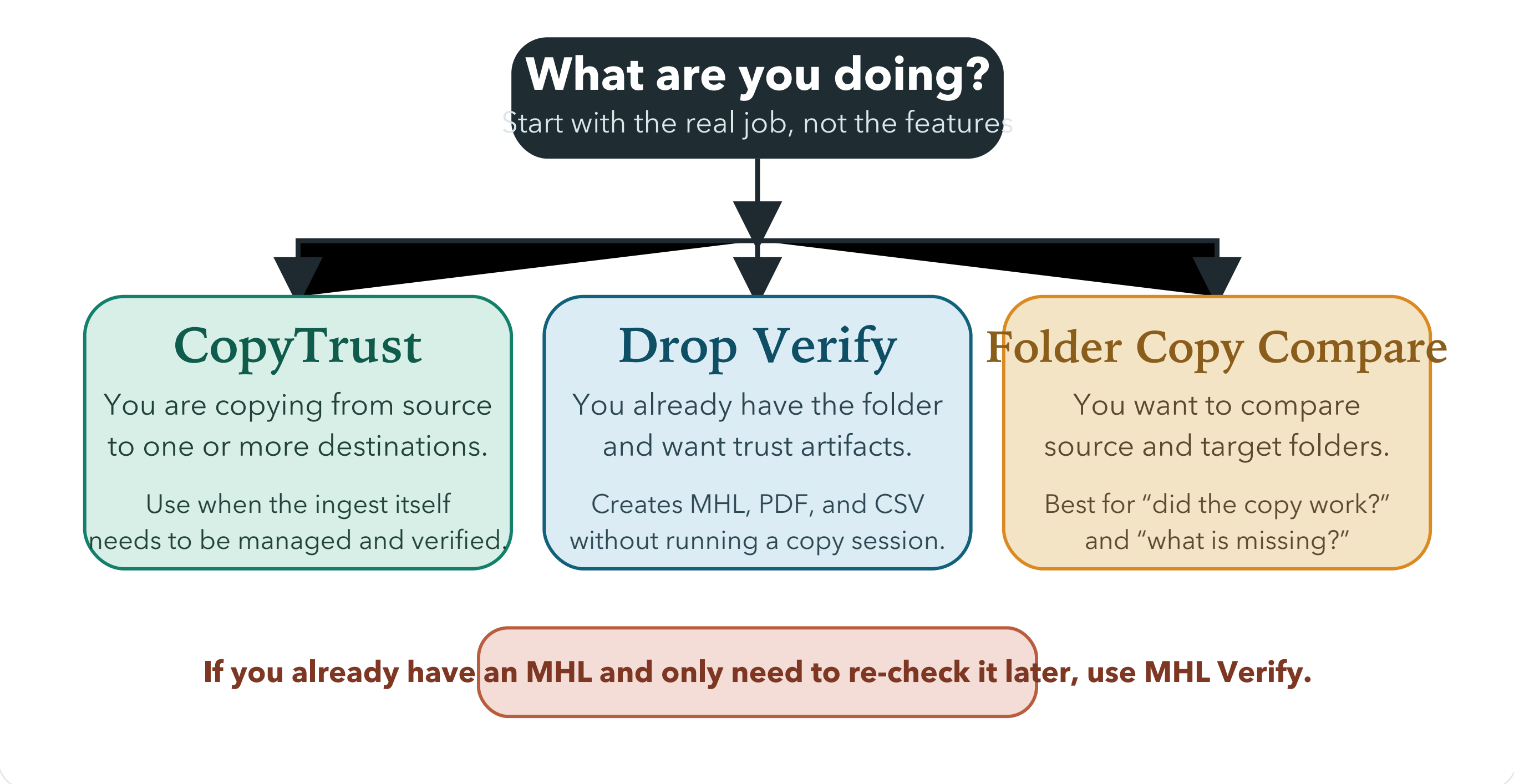
I want to compare two folders.

Best for confirming a copy made by CopyTrust, Finder, P5, rsync, or another tool.

- Quick Scan or Full Scan
- Shows missing, extra, different, identical
- Can copy missing files and generate or verify MHL

Fast Decision Flow

A visual shortcut for new users who just need to know where to begin.


What are you doing?
Start with the real job, not the features
CopyTrust
You are copying from source to one or more destinations.
Use when the ingest itself needs to be managed and verified.
Drop Verify
You already have the folder and want trust artifacts.
Creates MHL, PDF, and CSV without running a copy session.
Folder Copy Compare
You want to compare source and target folders.
Best for "did the copy work?" and "what is missing?"

If you already have an MHL and only need to re-check it later, use MHL Verify.

QUICK READING

Three simple operator questions

1. **Am I copying right now?** Use **CopyTrust**.
2. **Do I already have the folder and need proof artifacts?** Use **Drop Verify**.
3. **Do I just need to compare two folders?** Use **Folder Copy Compare**.

> New users usually do best when they ignore advanced options until the first successful run is complete.

CopyTrust Quick Start

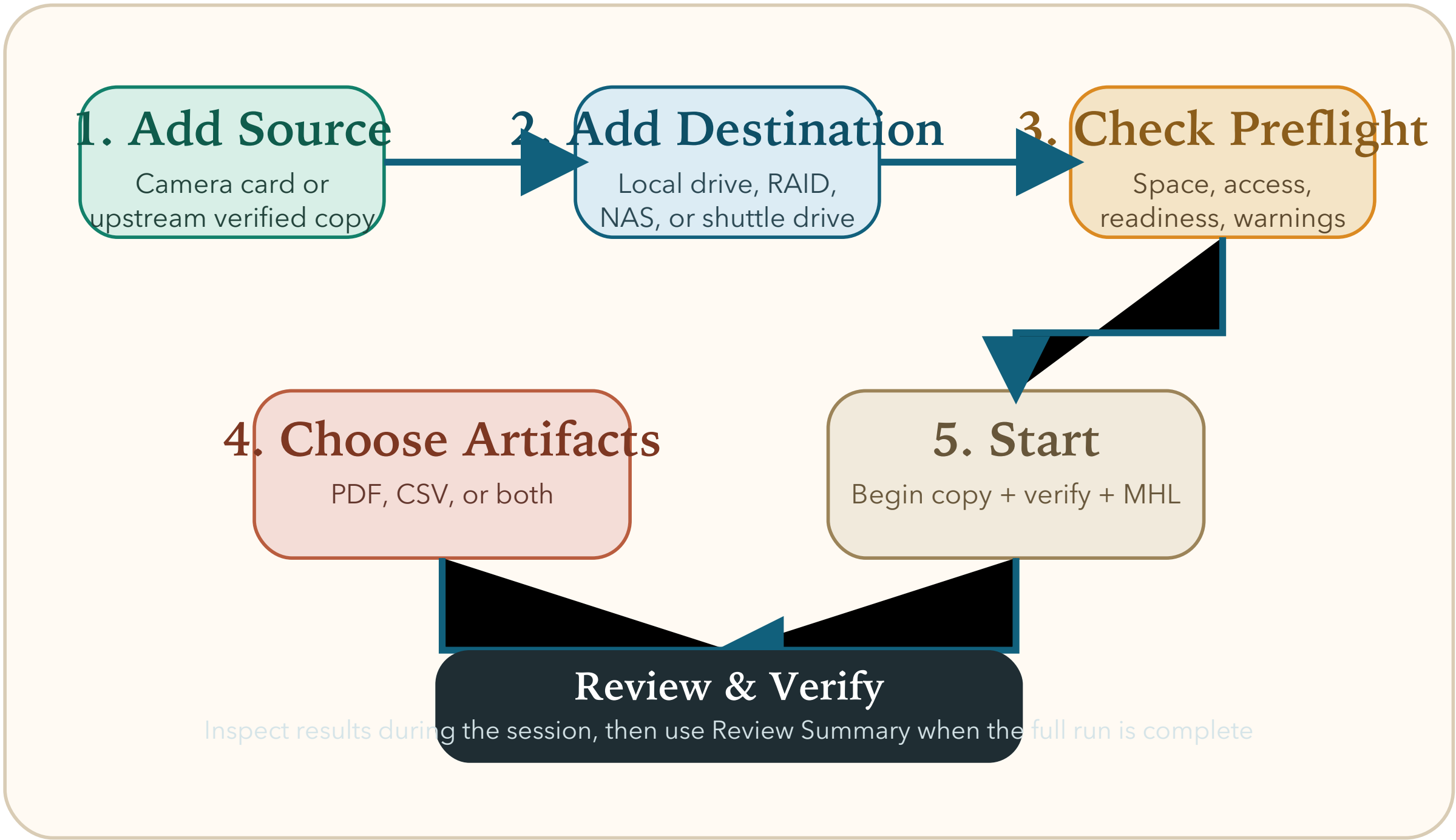
The in-app help is designed to keep the first job simple: add one source, add one destination, confirm preflight, and start the session.

QUICK START

First safe copy

1. Add **one source** and **one destination**.
2. Check that **preflight looks clean**.
3. Decide whether this session should create a **contact sheet PDF**, **EXIF/media CSV**, or both.
4. If you need richer metadata, confirm **ExifTool** is enabled.
5. If PDF is on, confirm **ffmpeg** for MXF and **REDline** for R3D when needed.
6. Click **Start** and confirm **Proxy: Off** or the intended codec and scale.

> During the run, **Review & Verify** lets you inspect the session without ending it. The 2.6 proxy beta shows per-clip progress and writes JSON/TXT/LOG evidence.


1. Add Source
Camera card or upstream verified copy
2. Add Destination
Local drive, RAID, NAS, or shuttle drive
3. Check Preflight
Space, access, readiness, warnings
4. Choose Artifacts
PDF, CSV, or both
5. Start
Begin copy + verify + MHL
Review & Verify

Inspect results during the session, then use Review Summary when the full run is complete

CopyTrust Workflow Options

New users should start with the direct session, then graduate to relay chains or mixed queues only when the job truly needs them.

METHOD 1

Direct Multi-Destination Copy

Use for `A -> B` or `A -> B` and `A -> C`.

- Add one source.
- Add one or more destinations.
- With two or more, leave the **Copy** switch on **Simultaneously**.
- Click **Start**.
- Review with **Review & Verify**, then end with **Review Summary...**.

METHOD 2

Relay Chain

Use for `A -> B -> C` when the first destination is the fast landing point.

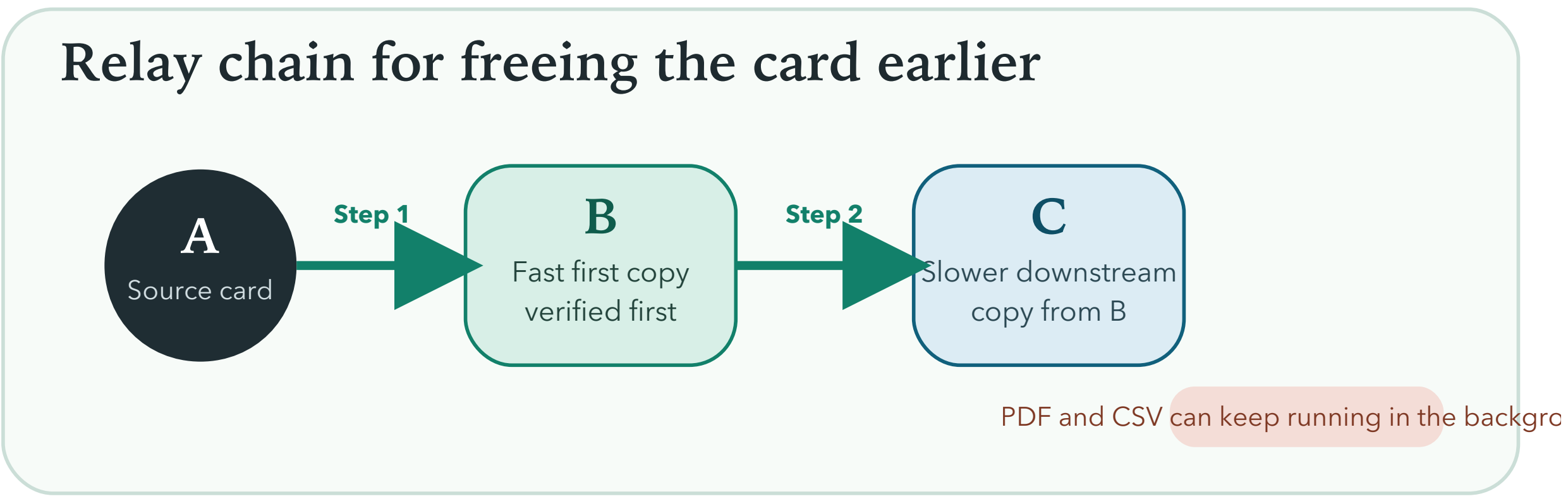
- Add one source and ordered destinations, fastest first.
- Set the **Copy** switch to **In series**.
- Click **Start** and confirm the pre-copy review.
- Each verified stop becomes the source for the next stop.

METHOD 3

Mixed Queued Sessions

Use when different cards need different destination sets.

- Build a setup.
- Click **Queue Current Session**.
- Build the next setup and queue it too.
- Run everything with **Start Queue**.


Relay chain for freeing the card earlier
A
Source card
Step 1
B
Fast first copy verified first
Step 2
C
Slower downstream copy from B

PDF and CSV can keep running in the backgro

ADVANCED START

When to use relay copy

1. Destination **B** is your fastest safe landing point.
2. Destination **C** is slower, remote, or network-based.
3. You want the original card free sooner.
4. You want CopyTrust to stage the legs in a clear order.

> Current guidance is to build relay copy from **one source + ordered destinations**, set **Copy: In series**, and click **Start**. One switch decides the topology, one button runs it, and the pre-copy review always appears first.

Drop Verify In One Screen

Drop Verify is the simplest way to create a trust package from a folder that already exists.

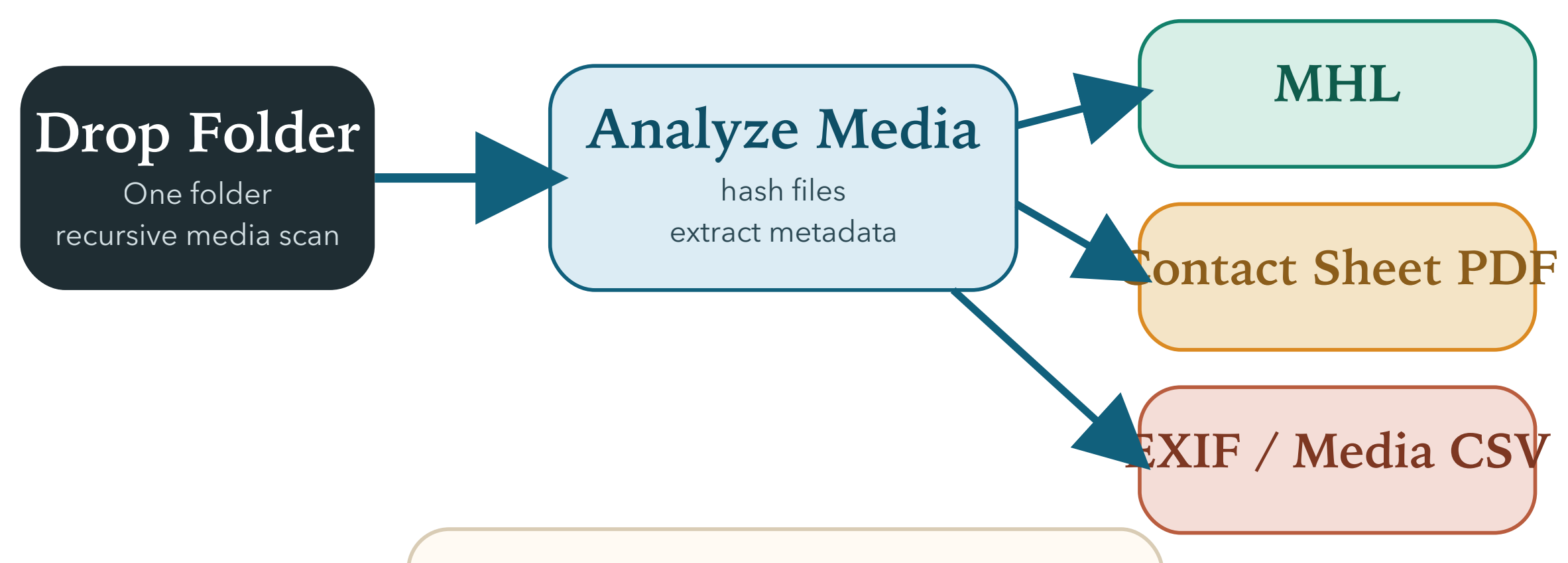
DROP VERIFY

What happens

1. Open **Drop Verify**.
2. Review settings and choose outputs: **MHL**, **Contact Sheet PDF**, **EXIF Camera Metadata CSV**.
3. Drop a folder into the window or choose it manually.
4. Drop Verify scans media recursively, hashes files, extracts metadata, writes CSV, renders the PDF, and saves artifacts.
5. Artifacts are written into `Receipts/` in the folder, or to an export folder when needed.

> If the source is read-only, Drop Verify can prompt for an export folder instead of trying to write to the original media. For a package such as `.fcpbundle`, 2.6 places receipts beside the package.

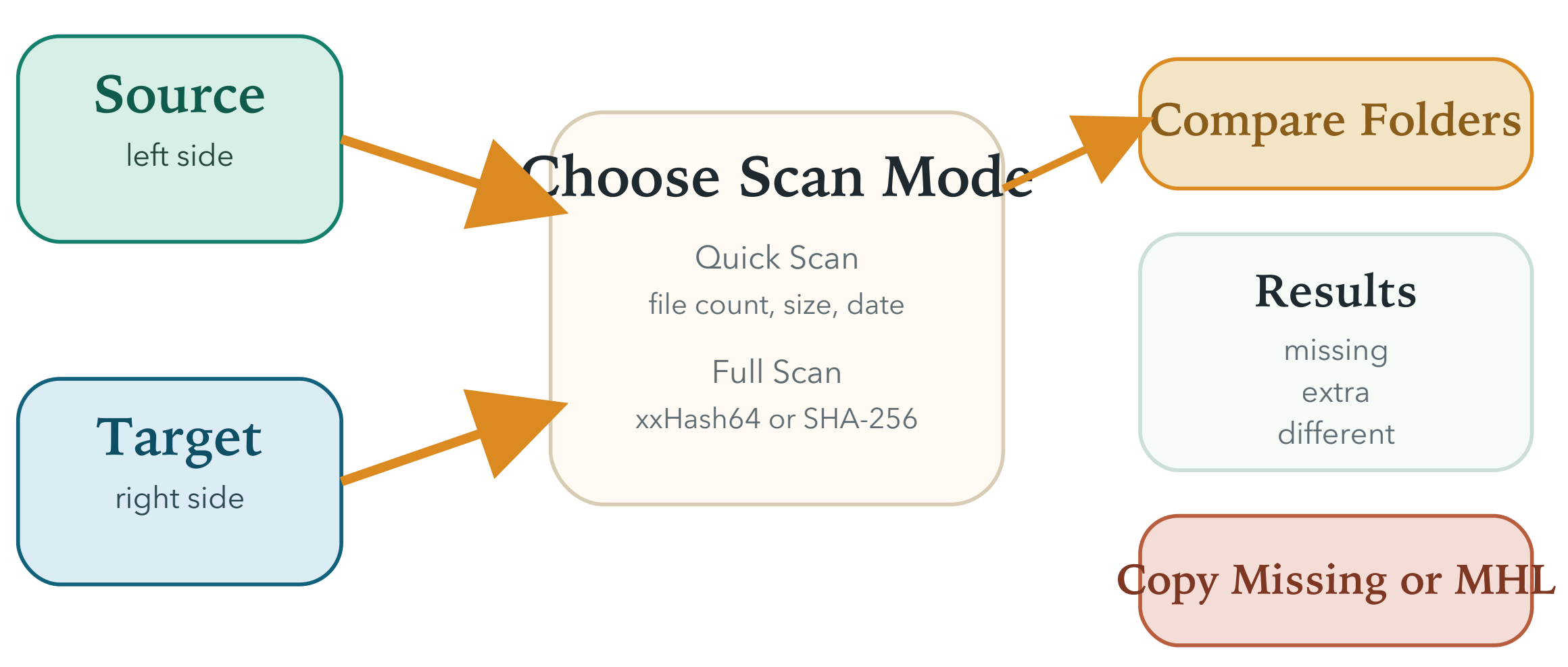
> Exclusion checkboxes are respected exactly as shown in Settings. Camera Card patterns such as `THMBNL`, `MISC`, `.THM`, and `.LRV` are optional and are skipped only when checked.



Artifacts write into `Receipts/` or an export folder.

Folder Copy Compare In One Screen

The original sanity-check tool in the suite: drop two folders, compare them, then repair or prove the result.



FOLDER COPY COMPARE

Best use cases

1. Confirm a copy after Finder, P5, CopyTrust, rsync, or another tool.
2. Choose **Quick Scan** for a fast surface check.
3. Choose **Full Scan** for content-level proof with hashing.
4. Use **Copy All Missing** to repair obvious gaps.
5. Use the **MHL** menu to generate or verify a manifest after a full `xxHash64` scan.

> If your main question is "what differs between these two folders?", this is usually the cleanest tool in the suite.

> Settings exclusions are checkbox-driven: enabled patterns are skipped during scans, while unchecked patterns remain included, including Camera Card folders such as `THMBNL`.